

film reviews

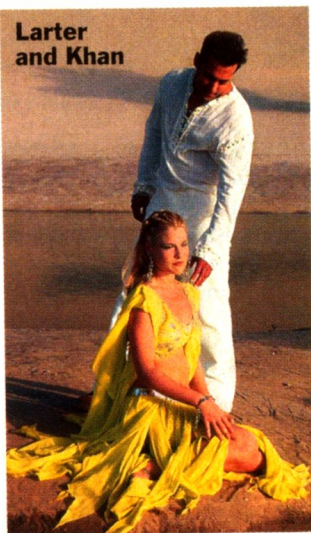
Failed Experiment

MARIGOLD

Director: Willard Carroll
Starring: Salman Khan, Ali Larter, Nandana Dev Sen

At one point in *Marigold*, a B-grade American actress with a bad attitude tells her boyfriend, a prince from Rajasthan slumming it as a Bollywood choreographer, that their love affair cannot work. It is simply a failed cross cultural experiment. Exactly.

Marigold is the cinematic equivalent of fusion



food in the hands of an amateur chef. It's undercooked, insipid and wholly unsatisfying. Hollywood director Willard Carroll

attempts to pay homage to Bollywood's fantastical song and dance traditions, but his storytelling is too limp and clichéd to pull it off with panache. So Ali Larter, who is attractive, but not particularly appealing, does the love tango with a somnambulist Salman Khan. For unintentional comic relief, there's Gulshan Grover playing a mercifully silent royal bodyguard and Nandana Dev Sen, as a princess-type who, when she cannot marry the prince, settles for Larter's rejected American boyfriend. They are as good as it gets in this film.

by Anupama Chopra

Tacky and Tasteless

BUDDHA MAR GAYA

Director: Rahul Rawail
Starring: Om Puri, Anupam Kher, Rakhi Sawant, Paresh Rawal

She calls him babes. And he frolics with her in striped underpants. She is Mahabanoo Mody-Kotwal, a fine theatre

Puri, Shorey, Rawal, Sawant

actor, and he is Om Puri. What are they doing in this embarrassing turkey, which plumbs the depths of toilet humour? Well, they'd have to ask their co-

actors, among them are Kher, Rawal and Shorey. Rawail probably convinced them they would be part of a satire on consumerism, the rise of tabloid tv and the dependence on false godmen. What he didn't tell them was that

Rakhi Sawant, baring cleavage and her desire to be "world famous in India", would look more respectable than all of them.

by Kaveree Bamzai

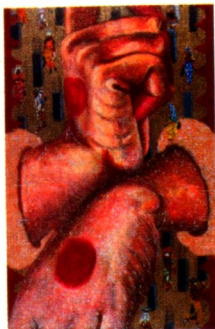


art

Handy Artwork

MUMBAI The recent works of M. Shantamani, on display at Chemould Prescott Road until September 6, are focused on hand gestures in acts of labour and celebration. Her work, so far, has been focused on industrial urban landscape. However, in her current collection of art work, one gets to see the emphasis on human

presence through her sensibility. Her work "Silent Speech: the Pace Between my Hands" is about one's growth and the idea of locating the self amidst it. In a quest such as this, the body assumes the stature of a metaphorical canvas on which subjective interpretation and transformations take place as the artist lay-

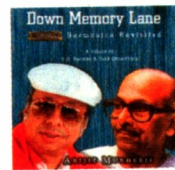


Shantamani's Exotica

ers it with codes and text that voice her social concerns. "Shantamani's art," says artist and art critic Suresh Jayaram, "is her attempt to return the spiritual to the material". The hand imagery is "heralding the return of the hand from exile into the mechanical world", Jayaram adds. by Swati Mathur

music reviews

Childhood Tunes



Hitz Today
Rs 150

DOWN MEMORY LANE

In the 1960s and 70s, the mouth organ was a much

sought after instrument, specially in films, due to the unadulterated music it produced. In this album, Arijit Mukherjee has tried to recreate the magic by playing film hits of Salil Chowdhary and R.D. Burman. The whole presentation has very little to do with the original musical arrangement. He has played popular melodies like *Zindagi kaisi hai paheli* (Anand), *Dil tadap tadap ke* (Madhumati), *Kiska rasta dekhe* (Joshilay). It is a good play for quiet evenings when you want take a stroll down memory lane.



Silk Road

BABY SITAR

It is scientifically proven that babies can hear external

sounds and melodies from the womb of their mother. Music plays an important role in the growth of any child, as well. Denis Teste, disciple of maestro Kushal Das, plays nine lullabies on the sitar accompanied by Jean Paul Le Golf on the piano. The melodies have been rendered using sounds within the range of frequencies accessible to baby's delicate ears. Excellent rendition. At a time, when most mothers either don't have time or have forgotten the traditional *loris* to put children to sleep, this album will come to their aid and lighten both the child's and the mother's mood.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit